

After **מלאך** calls **יצחק** **אבינו** on the **מזבח**, the **מלאך** prepares to perform the **עקדה**, placing **אברהם** **אבינו** on the **מזבח**, the **מלאך** calls **מלאך** **אלי** **מלאך** **ה'** **מן השמים** **ויאמר** **אברהם** **אברהם** **ויאמר** **הנני** (22:11). The **תורה** tells us that the **מלאך** called **אברהם** twice. The first time, it says (22:12) **כי** **מאומה** **לו** **תעש** **ואל הנער** **ואל תעש** **לו** **מאומה** **כי** **ירא** **אלקים** **אתה** **ולא תשכח** **את בנה** **את יחידך** **ממני**. The **מלאך** tells him: “Don’t harm him, because now I know that you are **אלקים**, **ירא** **אלקים**, for you did not withhold your son **ממני**.”

Then, the **מלאך** calls out to **אברהם** a second time (22:15-17):

ויקרא **מלאך** **ה'** **אל אברהם** **שנית** **מן השמים**: **ויאמר** **בי נשבעתי** **נאם** **ה'** **כי יען אשר עשית** **את הדבר** **הזה** **ולא תשכח** **את בנה** **את יחידך**: **כי ברוך** **אברהם** **והרבה** **אברהם** **את ורעה**

The Vilna Gaon points out that there’s a massive difference between the first calling of the **מלאך** to **אברהם** and the second. In the first the **מלאך** says, “You did not withhold your son **ממני** - from me.” Who is speaking here? The **מלאך** is speaking. But in the second **ברכה**, it says it is given *in the name of* **ה'**.

The **גר"א** asks a phenomenal **קשיא**: Why would the **מלאך** say **ממני**, from me? Was **אברהם** offering **יצחק** to the **מלאך**? Certainly not. How could the **מלאך** say, “You did not withhold your son from me”?

The **גר"א** provides an answer that almost only the **גר"א** could say. We know that every time a person does a **מצוה**, it creates a **מלאך**, and the quality of that **מלאך** corresponds to the quality of the **מצוה** itself. What qualities contribute to a **מצוה**? **אהבה**, **זריות**, **יראה**, **כוונה** - these aspects and others influence the quality of the **מלאך** created by the **מצוה**.

So who is speaking to **אברהם** **אבינו** now? The **מלאך** that was created through the **מצוה** of the **עקדה**. It is this **מלאך** who says, “Now I know that you are **אלקים**, **ירא** **אלקים**, for you did not withhold your son **ממני** - from me.” The **מלאך** is effectively saying, “Look at the level I represent; from my high **מדרגה**, you can see the greatness of the **שמים** **יראת** **אברהם** **אבינו**.” How do you know that I know? **ממני** - from me”. The quality of the **מלאך** created by the **עקדה** reflects the greatness of this **מצוה**.

This teaches us a profound **מוסר**. When we do **מצוות**, we should invest in them to elevate their quality. The **מדרגה** of our **מצוות** reflects the greatness of our achievements. If we put more **כוונה**, more time, more **ה'** **אהבת** **ה'** **יראת**, it translates into a greater **מצוה**. Whether or not our **מצוות** create a **מלאך** is not the main point - although if the **מדרש** says so, we believe it. The lesson is about the quality of our **מצוות**. Our **מצוות** should express our deep **כוונה**, our **ה'** **אהבת** **ה'** **יראת**, and that way, they will be of the highest quality. In the **זכות** of those **מצוות**, may **הקדוש ברוך הוא** grant us **ישועות**, **נחמות**, and **בימינו** **אמן** **במהרה** **צדק** **בזאת** **גואל** **אמן**!

